

THE COMPLETE CORPORATE RETREAT KIT

Everything you need to run a **leadership offsite.**

Handed the offsite and not sure where to start? This is the kit that makes you look like you've run a dozen — the questions, the agenda, the checklist, the budget, all ready to edit.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- | | |
|---|-----------------------|
| 1. 5 questions to align with your sponsor | 4. A prep timeline |
| 2. An editable 1.5-day agenda | 5. A budget worksheet |
| 3. The venue & logistics checklist | 6. What to do after |

Free from Building Teams · Be Legendary · buildingteams.com

Step 1

BEFORE YOU BOOK ANYTHING

Align with your sponsor in five questions

The offsites that go sideways are the ones booked before anyone agreed what it was for. Ten minutes with your exec sponsor on these five questions saves you weeks.

1. Why this offsite, why now?

What's the real reason we're pulling people out of their week?

2. What does success look like the Monday after?

One or two things that should be true when everyone's back.

3. Who is in the room — and who isn't?

4. What's off-limits? (topics, sacred cows)

5. What decision or commitment should the group leave with?

A retreat without a decision is a nice lunch. Name the outcome now.

Rule of thumb: the ratio that works is roughly $\frac{1}{3}$ **content**, $\frac{1}{3}$ **conversation**, $\frac{1}{3}$ **connection**. If your draft agenda is 90% presentations, it's a conference, not a retreat.

Step 2

COPY & EDIT

A 1.5-day retreat agenda

A proven shape you can adapt. Keep mornings for the hard thinking, afternoons for connection, and never end on a logistics note — end on commitment.

Day 1

TIME	SESSION	PURPOSE
Afternoon	Arrive, lunch, kickoff — the sponsor frames "why we're here"	Set intent & permission to be candid
	A shared experience / give-back build	Break hierarchy; create the story
	Facilitated debrief → the real conversation	Turn the moment into insight
Evening	Dinner (no agenda)	Connection off the clock

Day 2

TIME	SESSION	PURPOSE
Morning	The hard topic — strategy, alignment or the tension in the room	Do the work only this group can do
	Commitments — who owns what, by when	Turn talk into accountability
Midday	Close: each person names one commitment	Leave with skin in the game

Blank version to make it yours:

TIME	SESSION	PURPOSE

Step 3

NOTHING FORGOTTEN

The venue & logistics checklist

Walk the list before you sign anything. The items people miss are almost always A/V, breakout space and accessibility.

Space

- ☐ Main room fits the group in the layout you want
- ☐ A breakout space or two
- ☐ Natural light / a room you won't hate by 3pm
- ☐ Quiet space for a call / a break

A/V & power

- ☐ Screen, projector/TV, HDMI + adapters
- ☐ Mics for a room over ~25
- ☐ Reliable Wi-Fi + enough outlets

Food & comfort

- ☐ Meals + breaks ordered; dietary needs covered
- ☐ Coffee that doesn't run out
- ☐ Rooming list (if overnight)

People & access

- ☐ Travel / directions / parking sent
- ☐ Accessibility needs asked and met
- ☐ Materials, name tents, printouts
- ☐ A named point person on the day

Step 4**TIMELINE & MONEY**

Prep timeline & budget worksheet

WHEN	WHAT
6 weeks out	Sponsor alignment (Step 1), dates, venue held, provider briefed
4 weeks out	Agenda drafted, invites out, travel + rooming, F&B ordered
2 weeks out	Final headcount, run-of-show, pre-reads, A/V confirmed
Week of	Print materials, brief facilitators, logistics email
After	Send the commitments + photos; schedule the 30-day check-in

Budget worksheet

LINE ITEM	EST.	ACTUAL
Venue / meeting space		
Food & beverage		
A/V & production		
Team building / facilitation		
Travel & lodging		
Materials & misc.		
Contingency (~10%)		
Total		

MAKE THE OFFSITE THE PART THEY REMEMBER

We'll bring the experience that makes it land.

You've got the plan handled. The piece that turns a good agenda into an offsite people talk about for years is the shared experience in the middle — and that's exactly what we do. We come to your venue anywhere in the country.

[Get a proposal →](#)

or call **800-513-8759** · buildingteams.com

2,000+

EVENTS PRODUCED

4.76/5

FROM 25,000+ REVIEWS

Since 2003

NATIONWIDE